a year to a year and a half, and the launchpads would not be fully ready until early 1963. There were also problems with the missiles and accompanying equipment that Statsenko and his fellow division commanders were getting from the rocket builders. To meet installation deadlines, the commanders reported to Moscow that they had put the missiles on combat alert, when in fact, because of problems with new, untested, and often malfunctioning equipment, they needed another six months to prepare the launchpads and missiles for firing. The KGB reported that this was the case in the units headed by General Dmitrii Kobzar, who commanded a missile division in the same missile army as Statsenko. It appears to have been a common problem at the time.[7]

There were four missile regiments under Statsenko's command, two armed with Mikhail Yangel's R-12 missiles and two with his R-14s. The R-12s had an operational range of 2,080 kilometers: from the launchpads of one of Statsenko's regiments, located in Okhtyrka, they could reach Vienna, located 1,711 kilometers away, but not the next major Western city, Munich, at a distance of 2,162 kilometers. Missiles from the two R-14 regiments could hit targets at a distance of 3,700 kilometers. From their launchpads in the towns of Lebedyn and Hlukhiv they could reach Paris but would fall short of Madrid—two European capitals located, respectively, 2,710 and 3,994 kilometers from Hlukhiv, a former Cossack capital near the Russo-Ukrainian border and only 58 kilometers northeast of the village of Kalinovka, the birthplace of Nikita Khrushchev.

Statsenko's 43rd Division was part of the 43rd Missile Army, headquartered in the central Ukrainian city of Vinnytsia and commanded by General Pavel Dankevich. Statsenko's other superior there was Dankevich's deputy, General Leonid Garbuz—both Dankevich and Garbuz would be sent to Cuba along with Statsenko. Units of the missile army were deployed as far west as the Carpathian Mountains. That made Statsenko's division, located in northeastern Ukraine on the border with Russia, the unit farthest removed from targets in Central and Western Europe and thus dispensable when it came to transfer from the East European theater.

The plan for Operation Anadyr suggested that Statsenko move three of his four regiments to Cuba. The westernmost regiment, stationed in the central Ukrainian city of Uman and armed with R-12s, would stay in place,